

Table Filters

You can use regular expressions in the filter section in lieu of advanced filters. So if you want to look at all URLs that begin with google.com, type in the regex `^/google.com` in the filter section.

Goal Setting

GA has four different types of goals. We have discussed this in our chapter on Setting Up Goals and Tracking Performance. The four types are Destination, Duration, PPS (Pages/Screens Per Session) and Event. When it comes to these, Regex can come in handy. Think of Destination goals for instance. When people land up on the confirmation or thank you page, it will be considered a Destination goal for you. Instead of creating separate destination goals for multiple pages that are similar, use Regex. For instance, think of the example we discussed previously in this chapter. You could employ `'confirmation|thankyou'` instead of creating separate filters for the same.

Defining Funnel Steps

When it comes to funnel steps, the shorter the better is the rule of thumb. You can use regex to define funnel steps and set a goal at the end of the steps. If you wanted to define the most used landing page on your site as one of the funnel steps, you can use the dot star expression to include all URLs that contain the landing page.

Segmentation

If you notice, in all the reports, on the top it says 100% users and add segments. So by default there is no segmentation applied. You can set up segments using regular expressions easily and it will help you to analyse the data better leading to better decisions.

Regular Expressions are a boon and anyone who wants to use Google Analytics at the optimum level should know regex. In spite of its various benefits, many marketers do not use or even know how to use regex. Using regex helps you in improving the quality of your data which leads to better and more in-depth analysis and eventually better decision making. Of course, it's natural that better decisions will also increase your ROI and deliver enhanced returns. 